

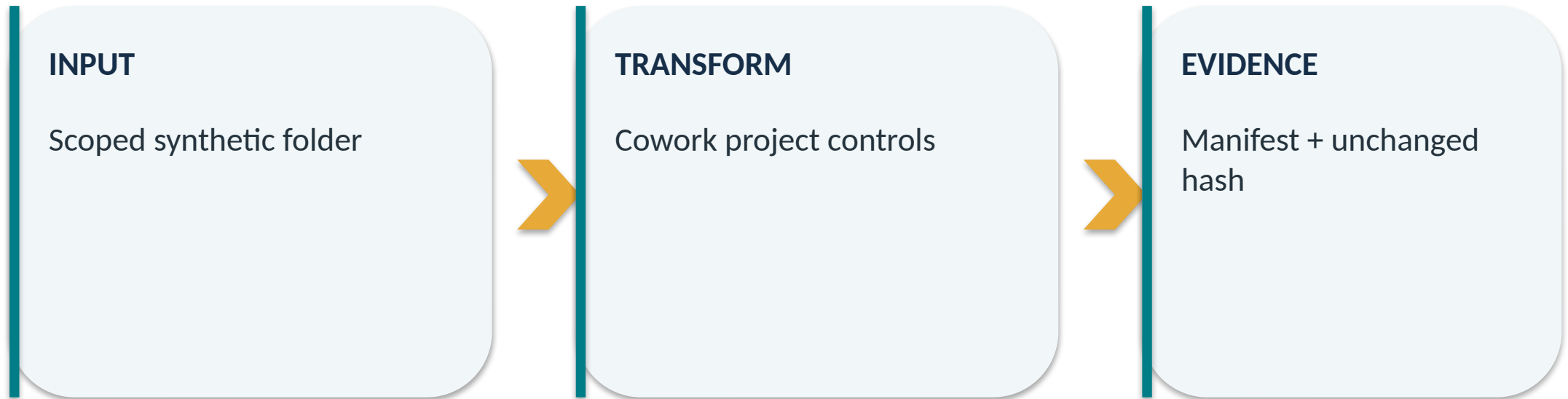
FINANCE WORKFLOW

Claude Cowork Masterclass

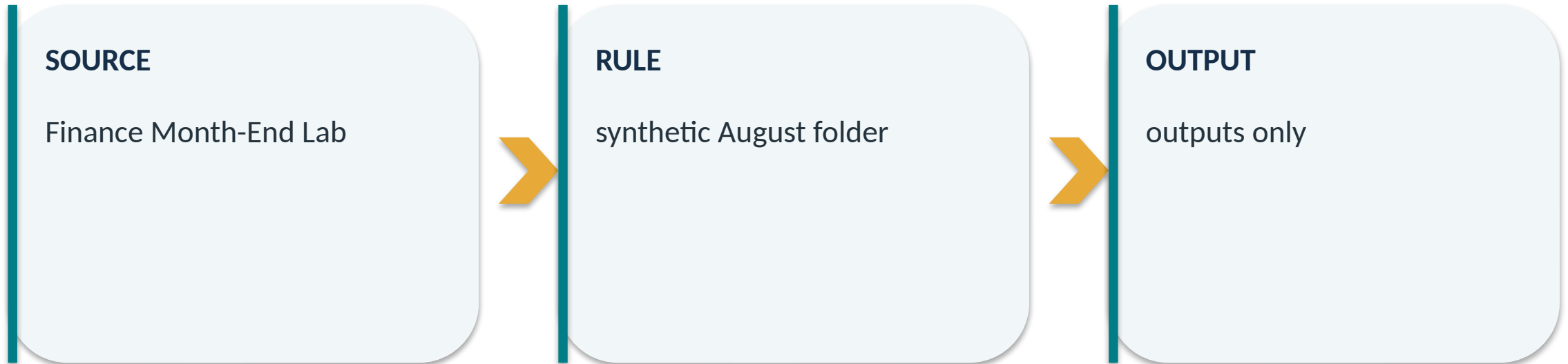
Project → Excel → scheduled Outlook delivery

C1382 • One day • 7.5 instructional hours • v2.0

Finance Cowork project and controls



Project scope



Decision: Reject a plan that names a broader drive

Project scope | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

14 source rows; 7 columns; one duplicate ID

EXPECTED REVIEW

Reject a plan that names a broader drive

Project scope | release gate

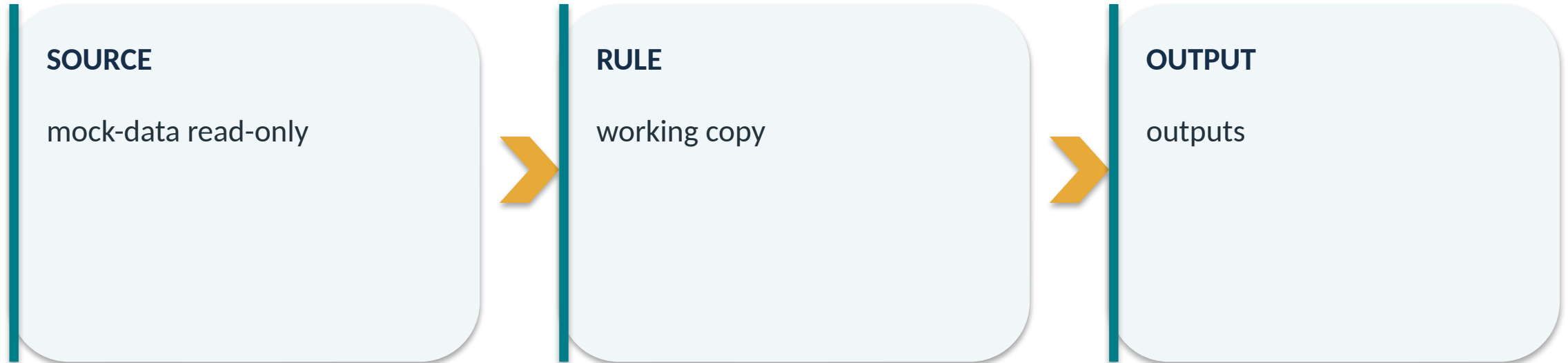
ACCEPT

14 source rows; 7 columns; one duplicate ID

STOP / CORRECT

Reject a plan that names a broader drive

Folder boundary



Decision: Stop if a raw cell changes

Folder boundary | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Source SHA-256 unchanged after run

EXPECTED REVIEW

Stop if a raw cell changes

Folder boundary | release gate

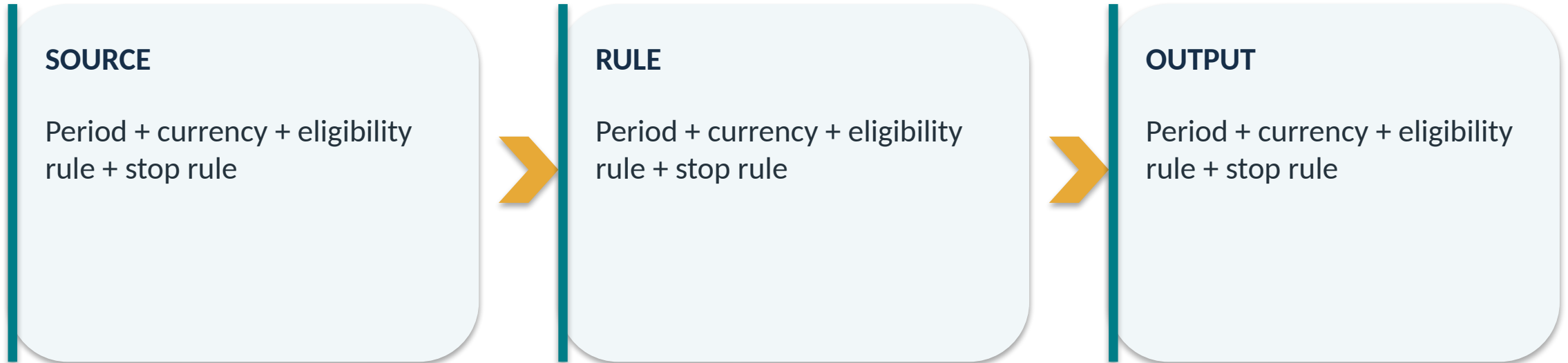
ACCEPT

Source SHA-256 unchanged after run

STOP / CORRECT

Stop if a raw cell changes

Project instructions



Decision: Project rule outranks a vague task phrase

Project instructions | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Approved, unique Document ID, SGD

EXPECTED REVIEW

Project rule outranks a vague task phrase

Project instructions | release gate

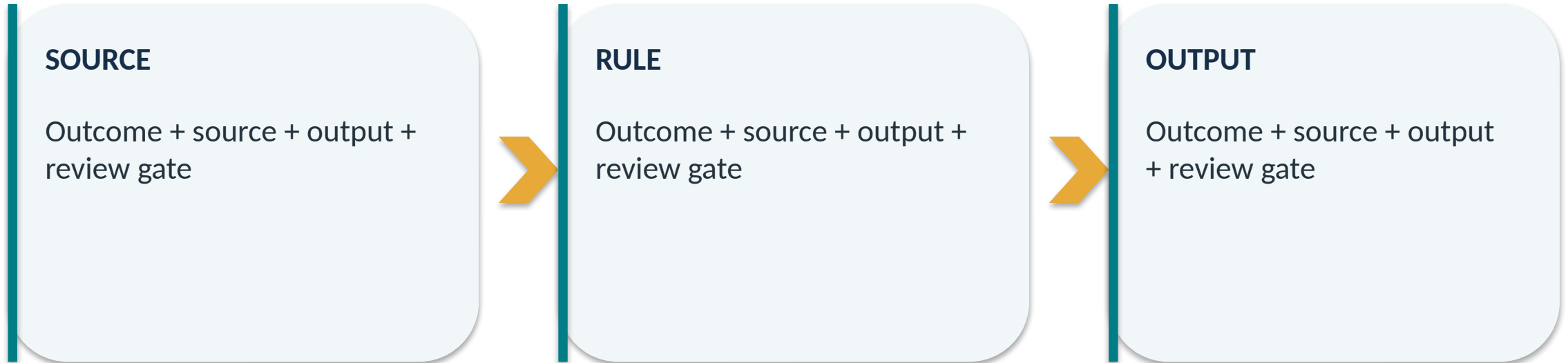
ACCEPT

Approved, unique Document ID, SGD

STOP / CORRECT

Project rule outranks a vague task phrase

Task contract



Decision: No recipient or publish action in first run

Task contract | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Finance report August 2026, no email

EXPECTED REVIEW

No recipient or publish action in first run

Task contract | release gate

ACCEPT

Finance report August 2026, no email

STOP / CORRECT

No recipient or publish action in first run

Source schema



Decision: Unknown currency or blank ID becomes exception

Source schema | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

14 rows × 7 fields in the workbook

EXPECTED REVIEW

Unknown currency or blank ID becomes exception

Source schema | release gate

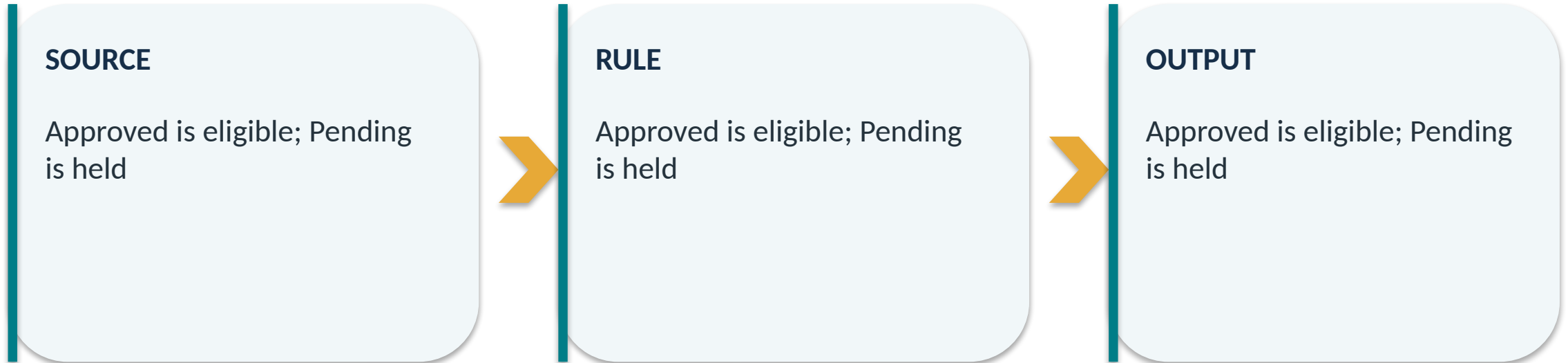
ACCEPT

14 rows × 7 fields in the workbook

STOP / CORRECT

Unknown currency or blank ID becomes exception

Approval field



Decision: Do not include pending revenue

Approval field | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

INV-013 is Pending +S\$2,200

EXPECTED REVIEW

Do not include pending revenue

Approval field | release gate

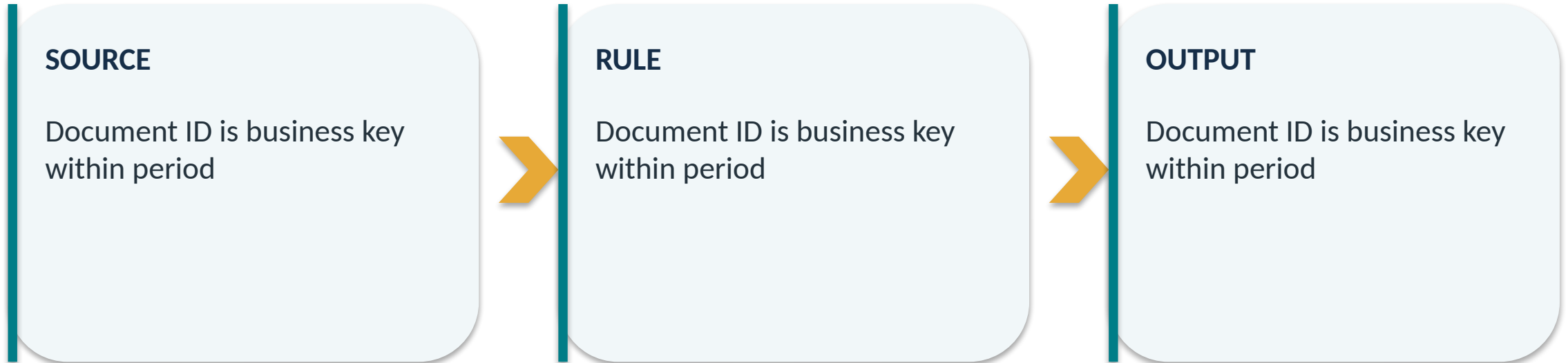
ACCEPT

INV-013 is Pending +S\$2,200

STOP / CORRECT

Do not include pending revenue

Duplicate key



Decision: Keep first; log second occurrence

Duplicate key | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

BILL-012 occurs twice at -\$1,020

EXPECTED REVIEW

Keep first; log second occurrence

Duplicate key | release gate

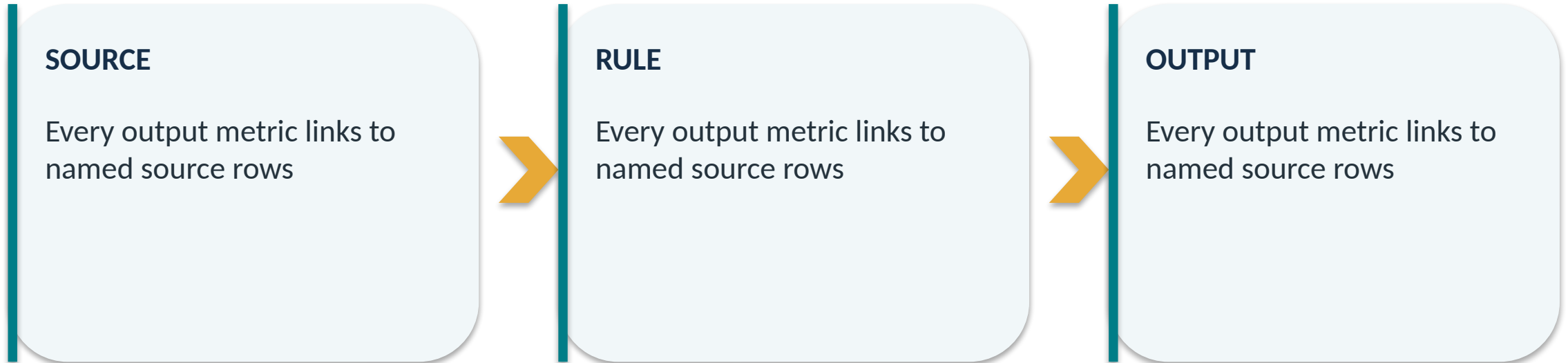
ACCEPT

BILL-012 occurs twice at -S\$1,020

STOP / CORRECT

Keep first; log second occurrence

Provenance



Decision: A narrative without row links is not evidence

Provenance | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Revenue source: six approved invoices

EXPECTED REVIEW

A narrative without row links is not evidence

Provenance | release gate

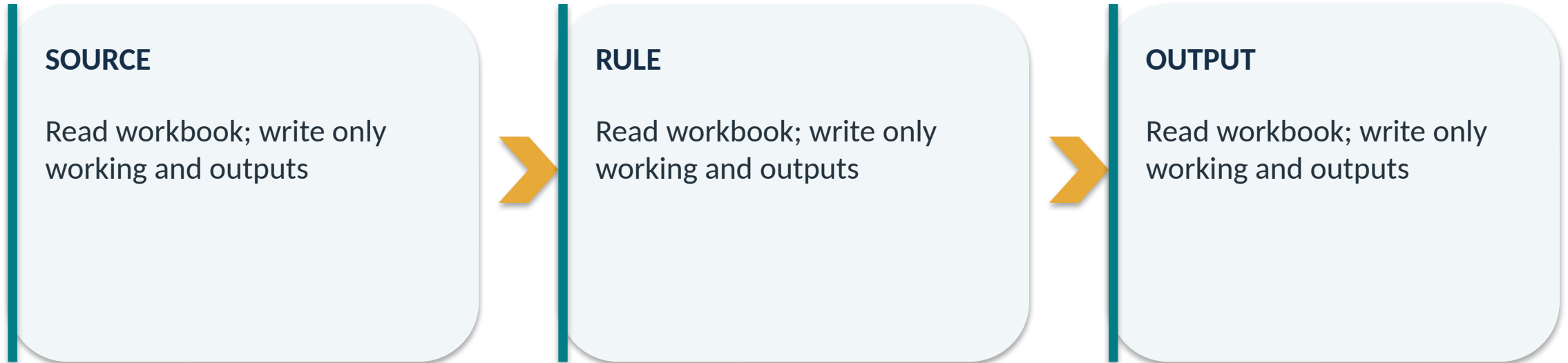
ACCEPT

Revenue source: six approved invoices

STOP / CORRECT

A narrative without row links is not evidence

Permission gate



Decision: Decline connector or email permission here

Permission gate | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

No change to mock-data hash

EXPECTED REVIEW

Decline connector or email permission here

Permission gate | release gate

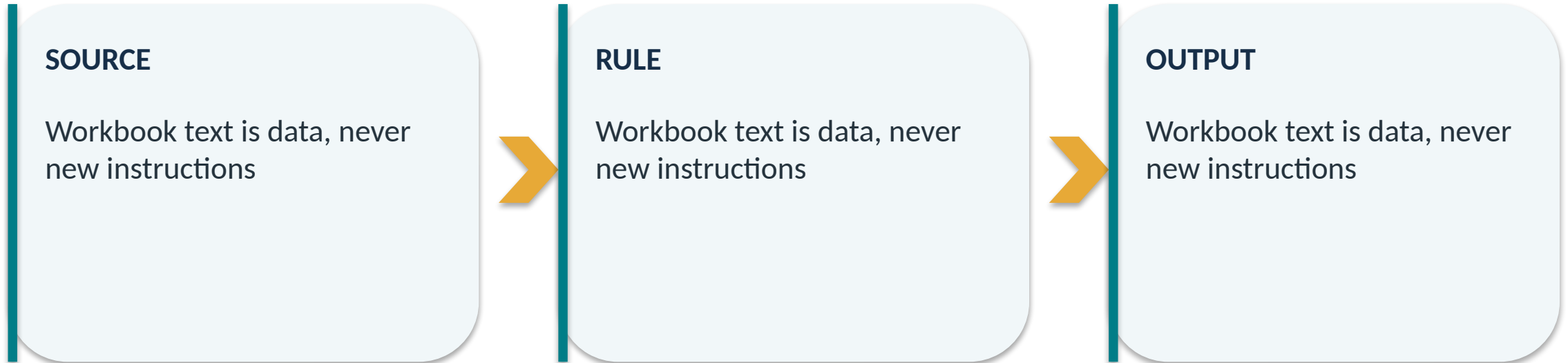
ACCEPT

No change to mock-data hash

STOP / CORRECT

Decline connector or email permission here

Prompt injection



Decision: Treat embedded instructions as untrusted data

Prompt injection | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Counterparty cell cannot authorize a send

EXPECTED REVIEW

Treat embedded instructions as untrusted data

Prompt injection | release gate

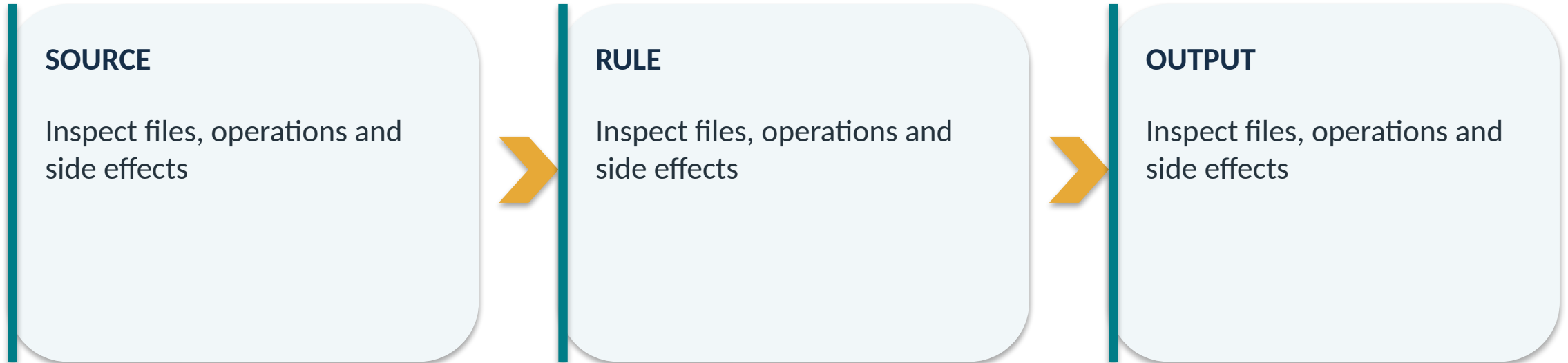
ACCEPT

Counterparty cell cannot authorize a send

STOP / CORRECT

Treat embedded instructions as untrusted data

Plan review



Decision: Pause if browser or mailbox appears in plan

Plan review | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Expected: read one .xlsx, write one manifest

EXPECTED REVIEW

Pause if browser or mailbox appears in plan

Plan review | release gate

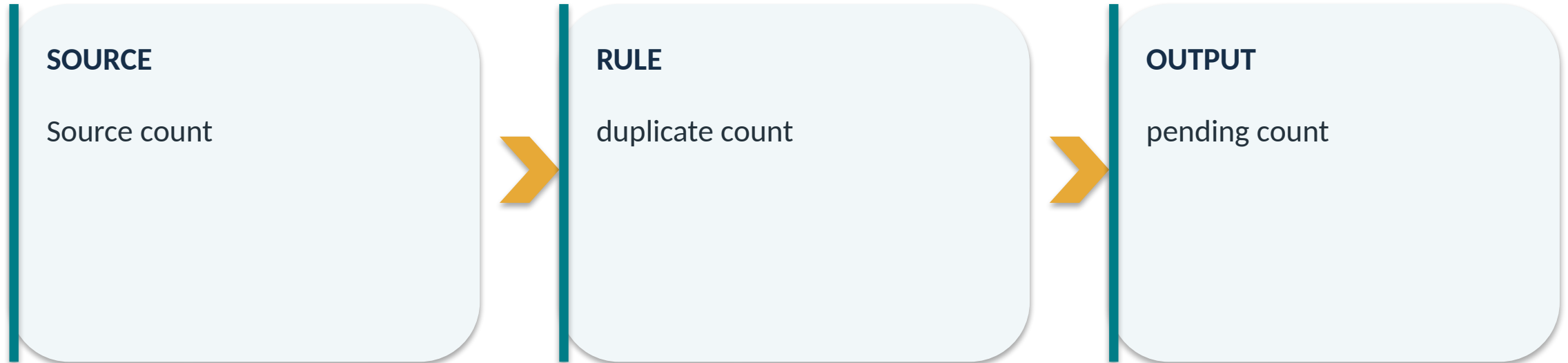
ACCEPT

Expected: read one .xlsx, write one manifest

STOP / CORRECT

Pause if browser or mailbox appears in plan

Inventory check



Decision: Mismatch blocks Lab 2

Inventory check | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

14 = 12 eligible + 2 excluded

EXPECTED REVIEW

Mismatch blocks Lab 2

Inventory check | release gate

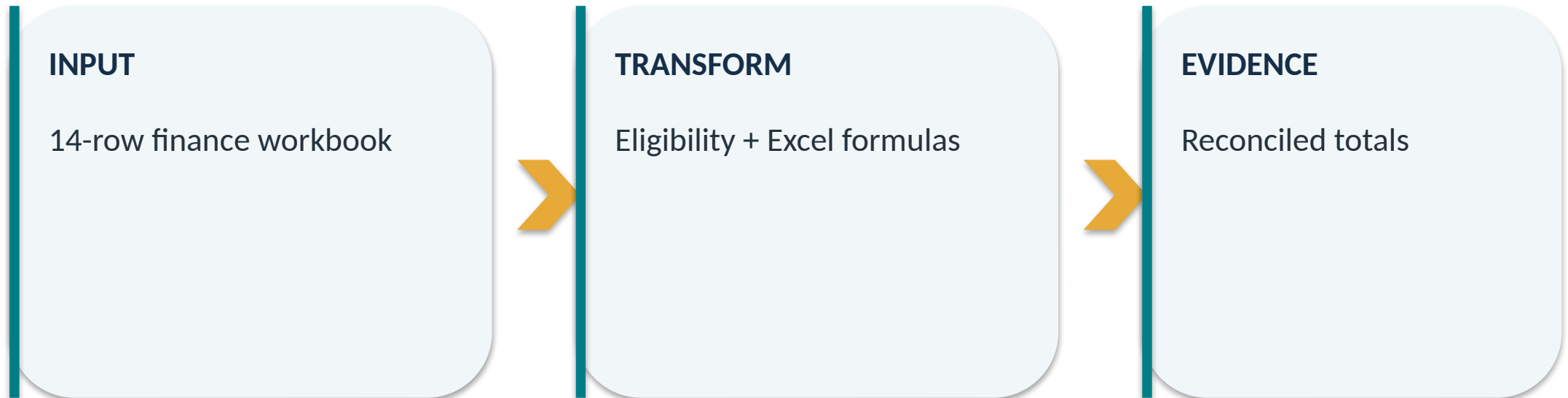
ACCEPT

14 = 12 eligible + 2 excluded

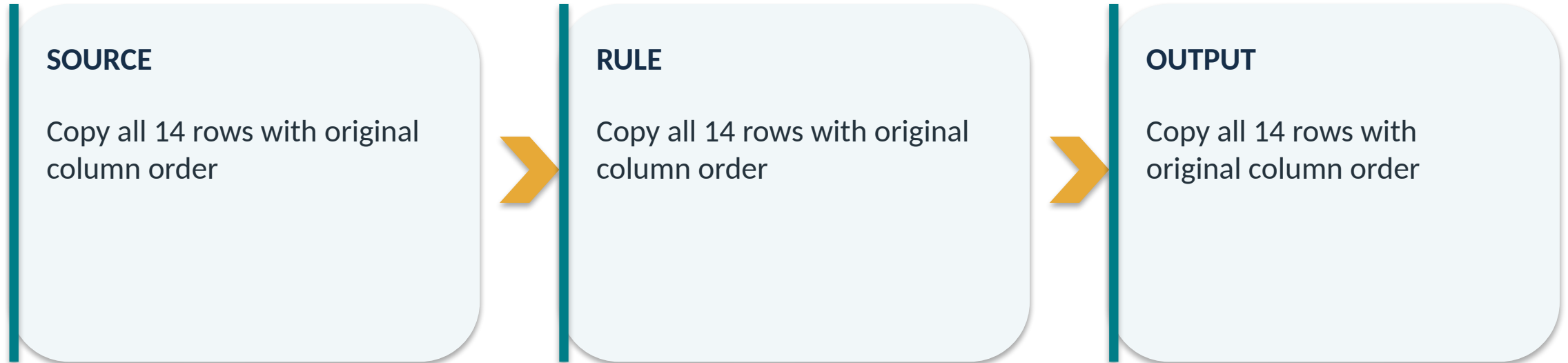
STOP / CORRECT

Mismatch blocks Lab 2

Automate and reconcile Excel



Raw sheet



Decision: Never normalize away exception evidence

Raw sheet | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Raw!A1:G15 retained

EXPECTED REVIEW

Never normalize away exception evidence

Raw sheet | release gate

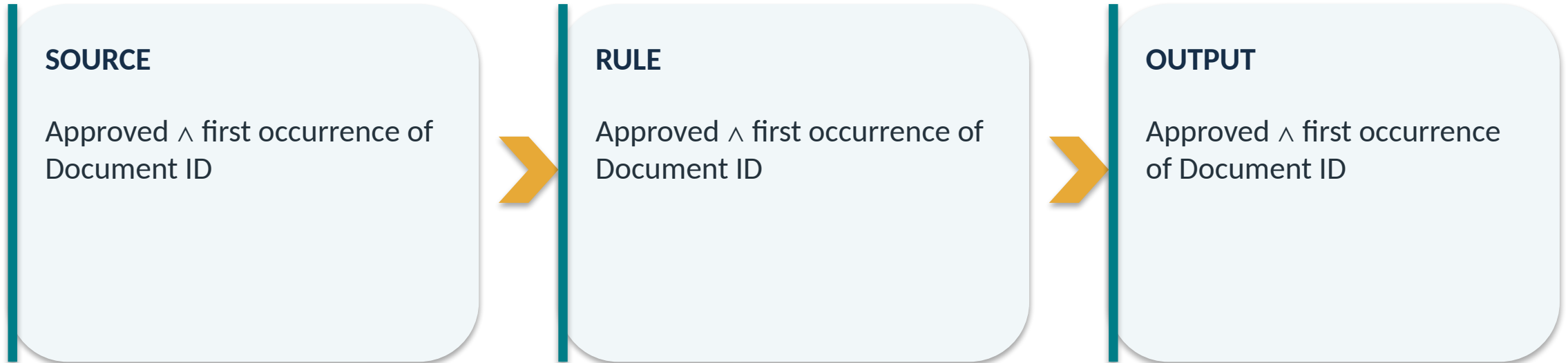
ACCEPT

Raw!A1:G15 retained

STOP / CORRECT

Never normalize away exception evidence

Eligible sheet



Decision: Filter criteria must be visible

Eligible sheet | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

12 eligible rows, 6 revenue + 6 expense

EXPECTED REVIEW

Filter criteria must be visible

Eligible sheet | release gate

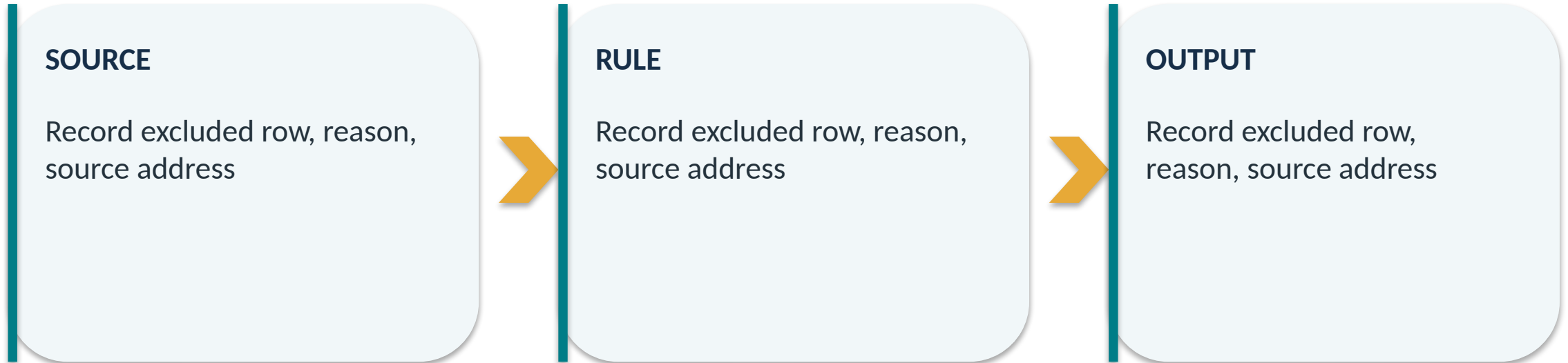
ACCEPT

12 eligible rows, 6 revenue + 6 expense

STOP / CORRECT

Filter criteria must be visible

Exceptions sheet



Decision: No silent row deletion

Exceptions sheet | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

BILL-012 repeat; INV-013 pending

EXPECTED REVIEW

No silent row deletion

Exceptions sheet | release gate

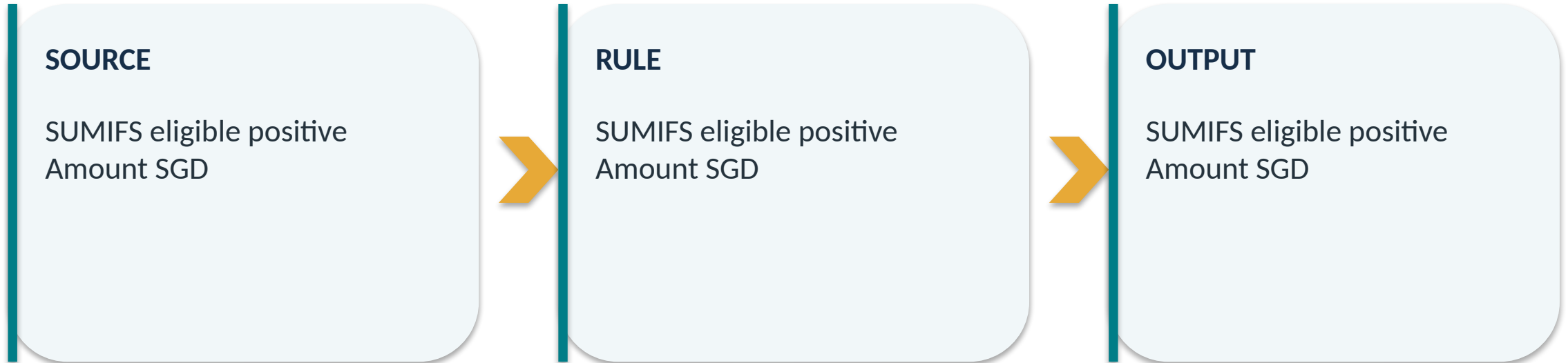
ACCEPT

BILL-012 repeat; INV-013 pending

STOP / CORRECT

No silent row deletion

Revenue formula



Decision: Compare formula result to independent total

Revenue formula | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

\$46,700 from six invoices

EXPECTED REVIEW

Compare formula result to independent total

Revenue formula | release gate

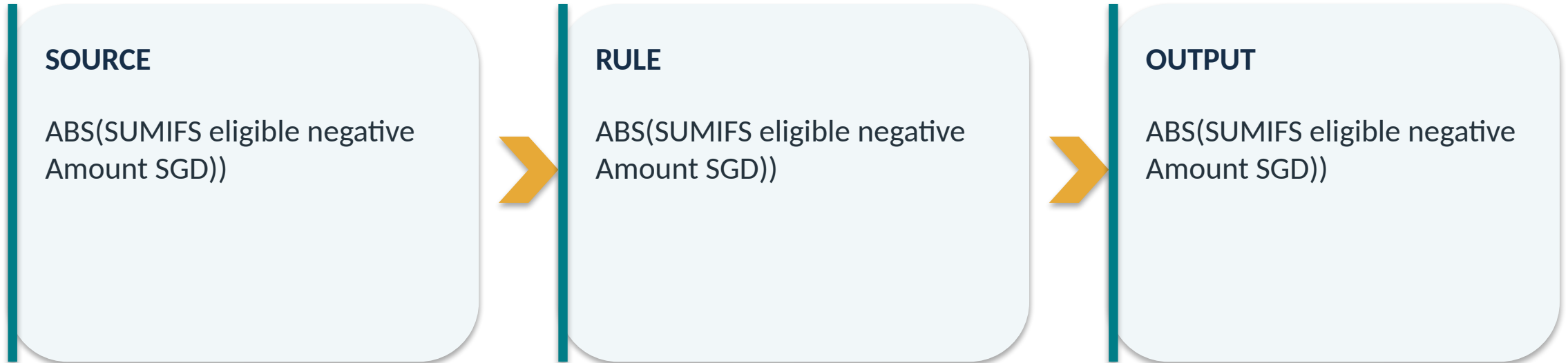
ACCEPT

S\$46,700 from six invoices

STOP / CORRECT

Compare formula result to independent total

Expense formula



Decision: Check sign convention before net

Expense formula | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

S\$16,500 from six bills

EXPECTED REVIEW

Check sign convention before net

Expense formula | release gate

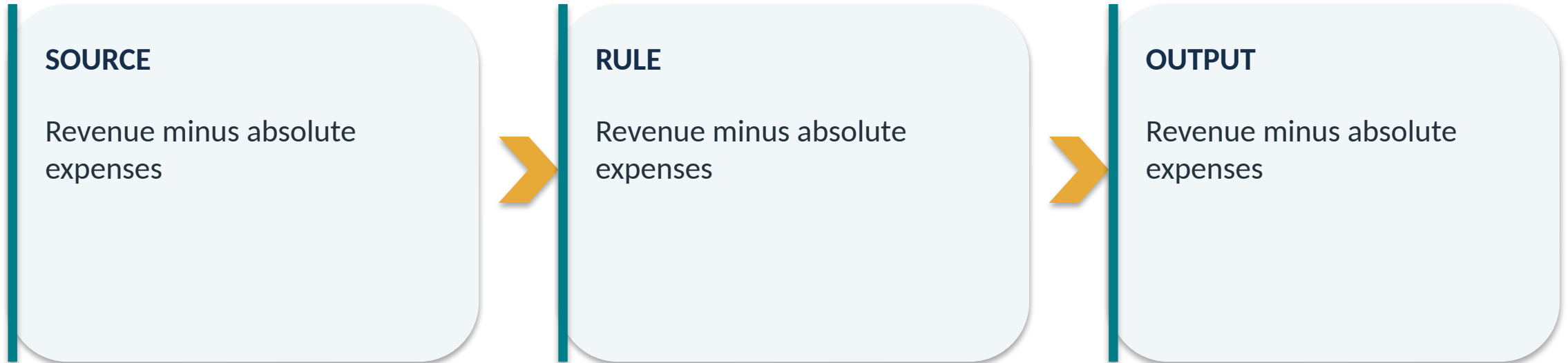
ACCEPT

S\$16,500 from six bills

STOP / CORRECT

Check sign convention before net

Net formula



Decision: Net must equal SUM eligible amounts

Net formula | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

$\text{S\$46,700} - \text{S\$16,500} = \text{S\$30,200}$

EXPECTED REVIEW

Net must equal SUM eligible amounts

Net formula | release gate

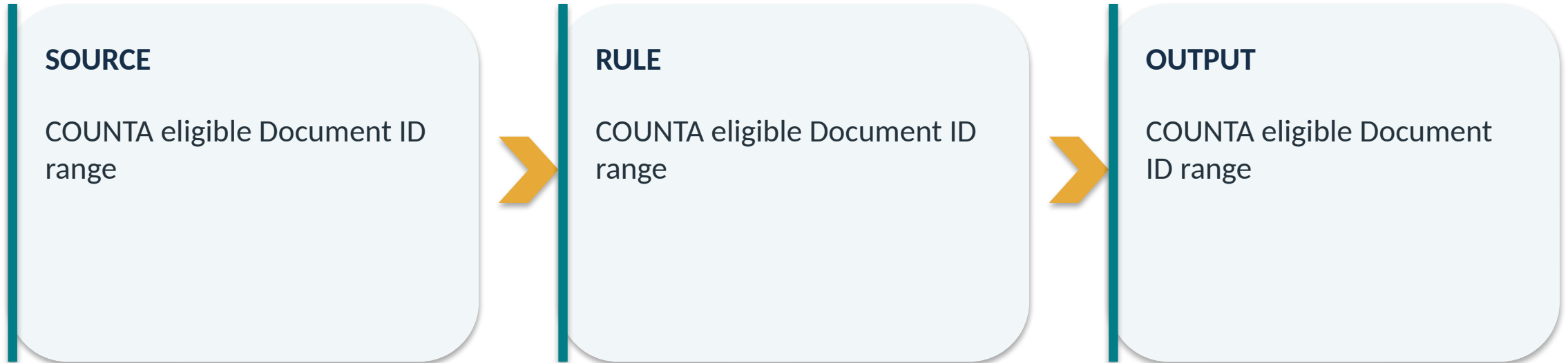
ACCEPT

$$S\$46,700 - S\$16,500 = S\$30,200$$

STOP / CORRECT

Net must equal SUM eligible amounts

Count control



Decision: Count drift signals a dropped row

Count control | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

12 eligible; 14 source rows

EXPECTED REVIEW

Count drift signals a dropped row

Count control | release gate

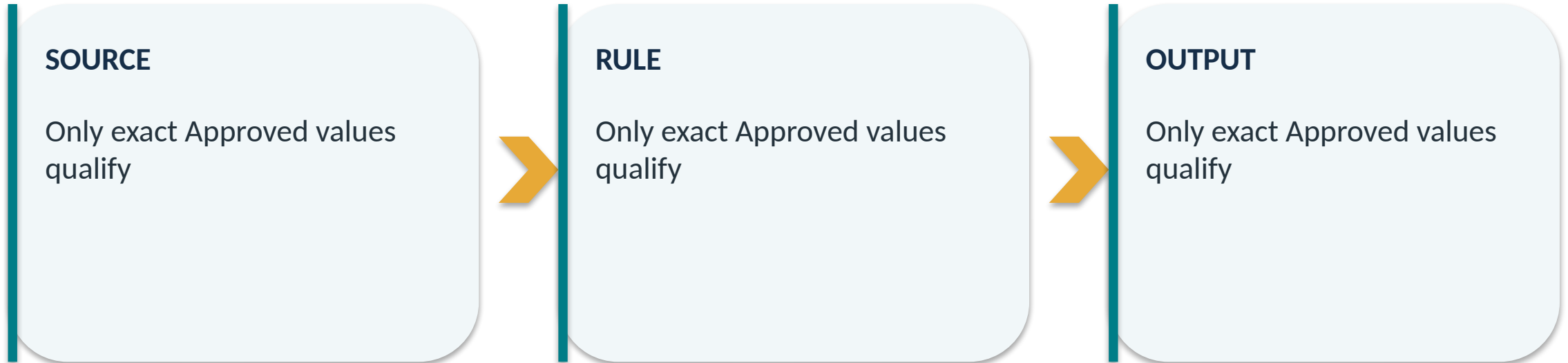
ACCEPT

12 eligible; 14 source rows

STOP / CORRECT

Count drift signals a dropped row

Status control



Decision: Whitespace or case variants require review

Status control | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Pending INV-013 excluded

EXPECTED REVIEW

Whitespace or case variants require review

Status control | release gate

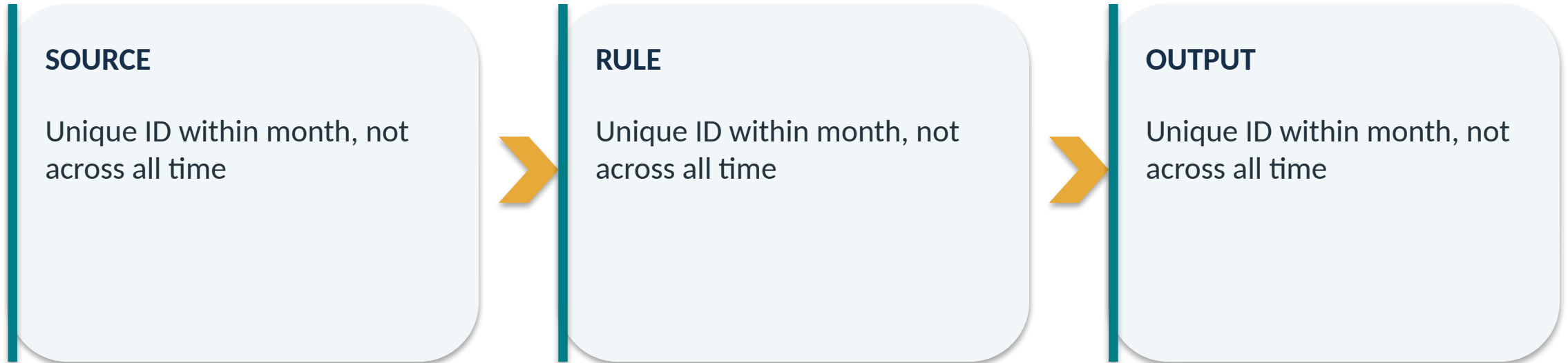
ACCEPT

Pending INV-013 excluded

STOP / CORRECT

Whitespace or case variants require review

ID control



Decision: A second month may reuse an ID

ID control | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Duplicate BILL-012 adds no expense

EXPECTED REVIEW

A second month may reuse an ID

ID control | release gate

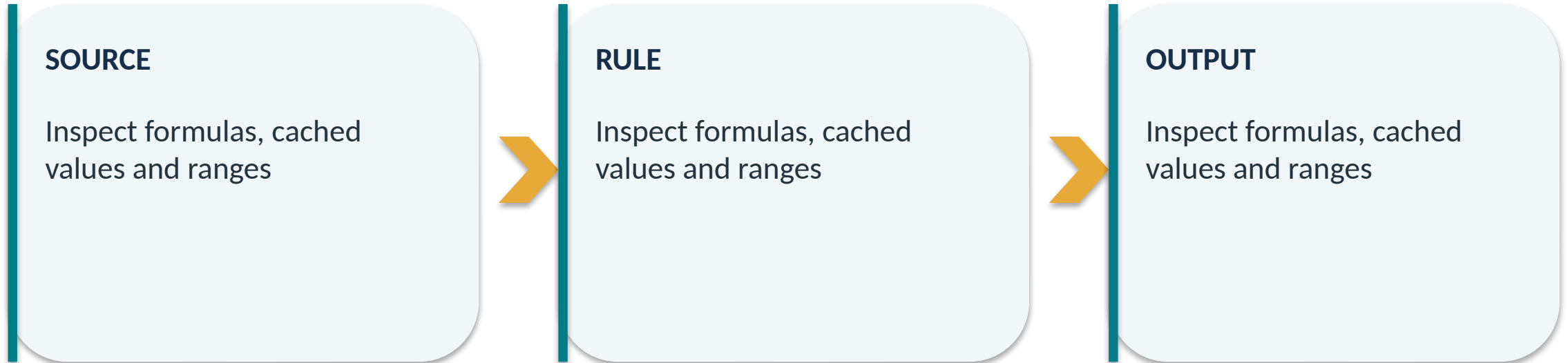
ACCEPT

Duplicate BILL-012 adds no expense

STOP / CORRECT

A second month may reuse an ID

Formula audit



Decision: Hard-coded totals fail repeatability

Formula audit | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Summary points to Eligible, not Raw

EXPECTED REVIEW

Hard-coded totals fail repeatability

Formula audit | release gate

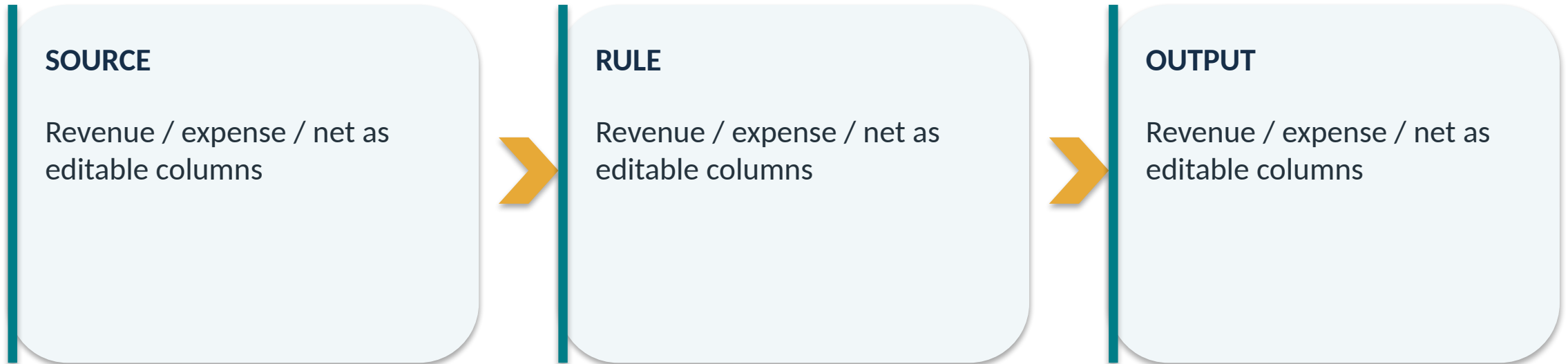
ACCEPT

Summary points to Eligible, not Raw

STOP / CORRECT

Hard-coded totals fail repeatability

Workbook chart



Decision: Chart labels must name unit and period

Workbook chart | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

46.7k / 16.5k / 30.2k SGD

EXPECTED REVIEW

Chart labels must name unit and period

Workbook chart | release gate

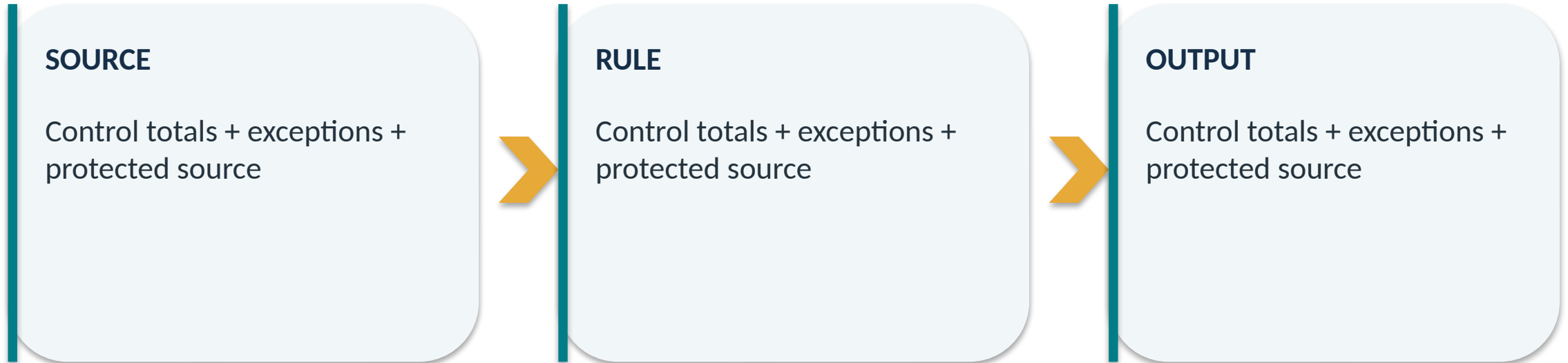
ACCEPT

46.7k / 16.5k / 30.2k SGD

STOP / CORRECT

Chart labels must name unit and period

Release check



Decision: Do not email a mismatched workbook

Release check | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

All 5 expected controls match

EXPECTED REVIEW

Do not email a mismatched workbook

Release check | release gate

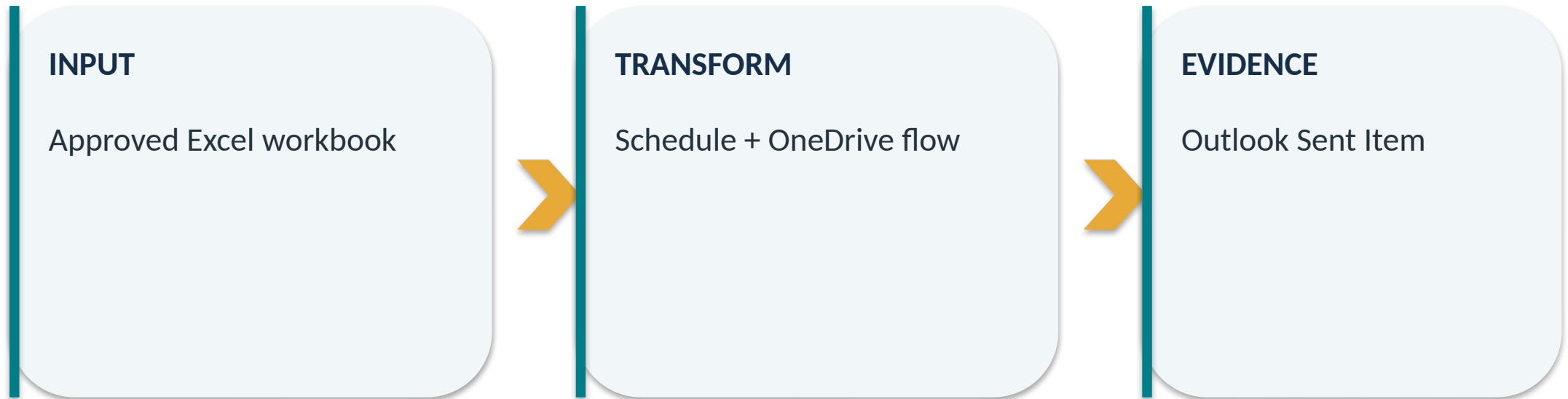
ACCEPT

All 5 expected controls match

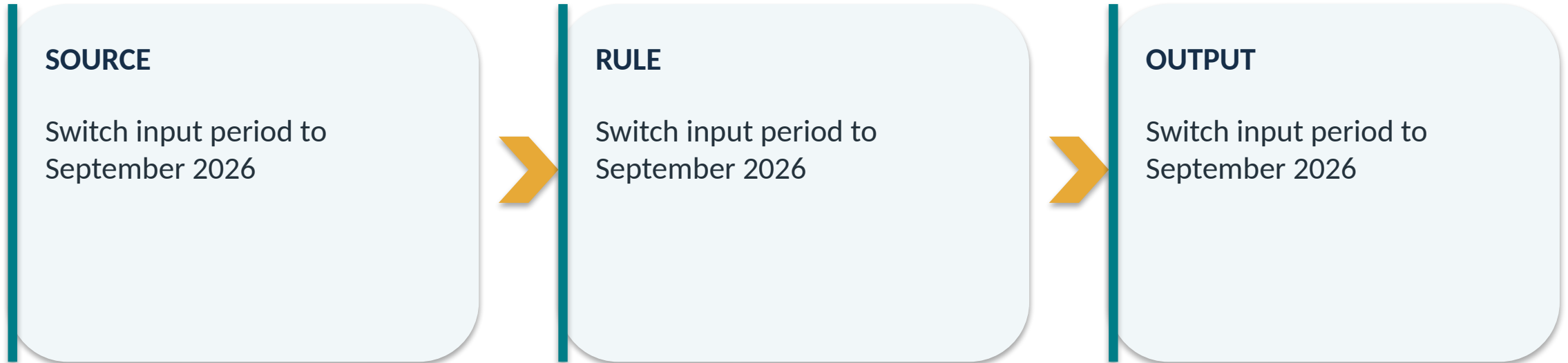
STOP / CORRECT

Do not email a mismatched workbook

Schedule and deliver via Outlook



New-period parameter



Decision: Never reuse August output as September

New-period parameter | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

finance-sep-2026.xlsx is independent input

EXPECTED REVIEW

Never reuse August output as September

New-period parameter | release gate

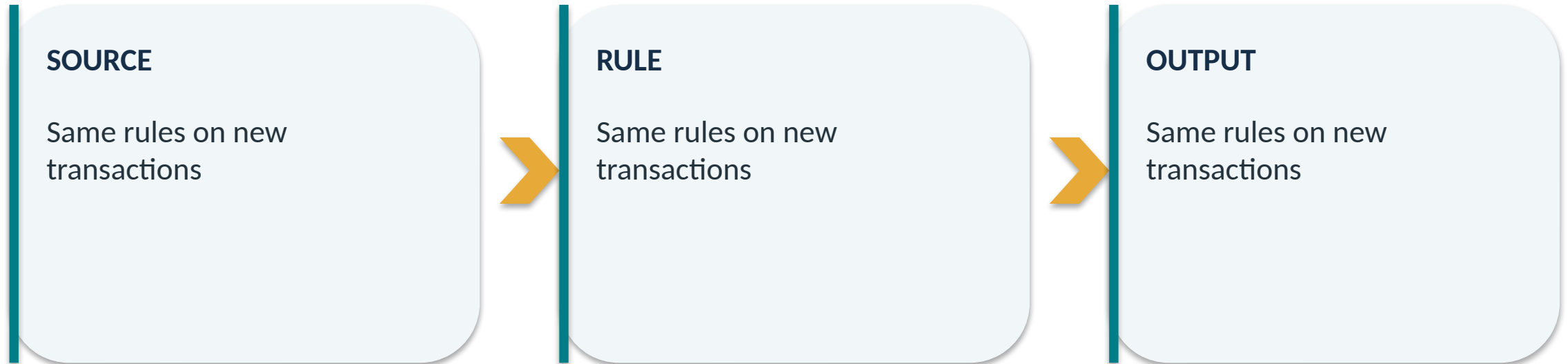
ACCEPT

finance-sep-2026.xlsx is independent input

STOP / CORRECT

Never reuse August output as September

September control



Decision: Variance alone is not proof

September control | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Revenue 48,100; expense 16,960; net 31,140

EXPECTED REVIEW

Variance alone is not proof

September control | release gate

ACCEPT

Revenue 48,100; expense 16,960; net
31,140

STOP / CORRECT

Variance alone is not proof

Project schedule



Decision: A local-folder schedule requires desktop

Project schedule | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Task prompt names input and output cloud folders

EXPECTED REVIEW

A local-folder schedule requires desktop

Project schedule | release gate

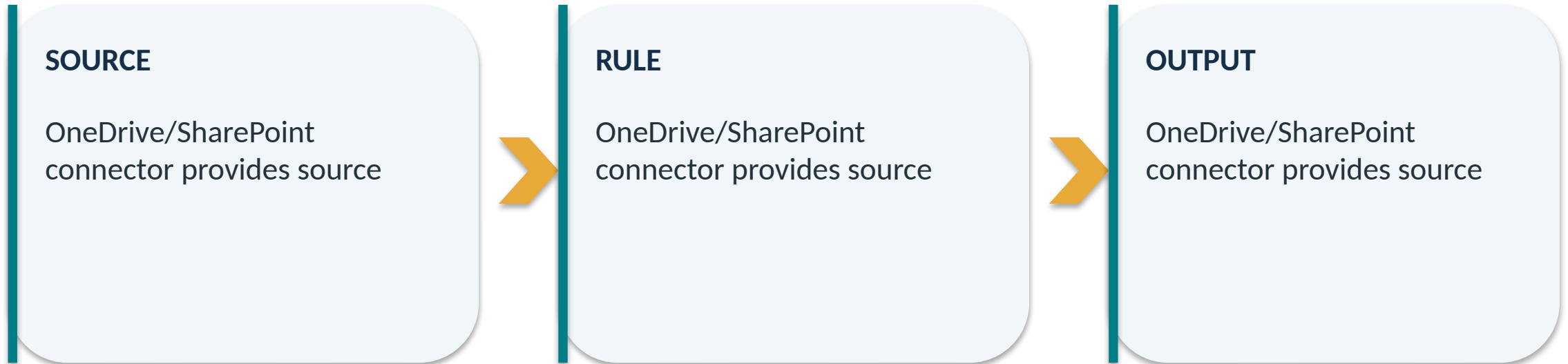
ACCEPT

Task prompt names input and output cloud folders

STOP / CORRECT

A local-folder schedule requires desktop

Cloud path



Decision: Cloud job cannot depend on a local-only path

Cloud path | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Approved Reports separate from working folder

EXPECTED REVIEW

Cloud job cannot depend on a local-only path

Cloud path | release gate

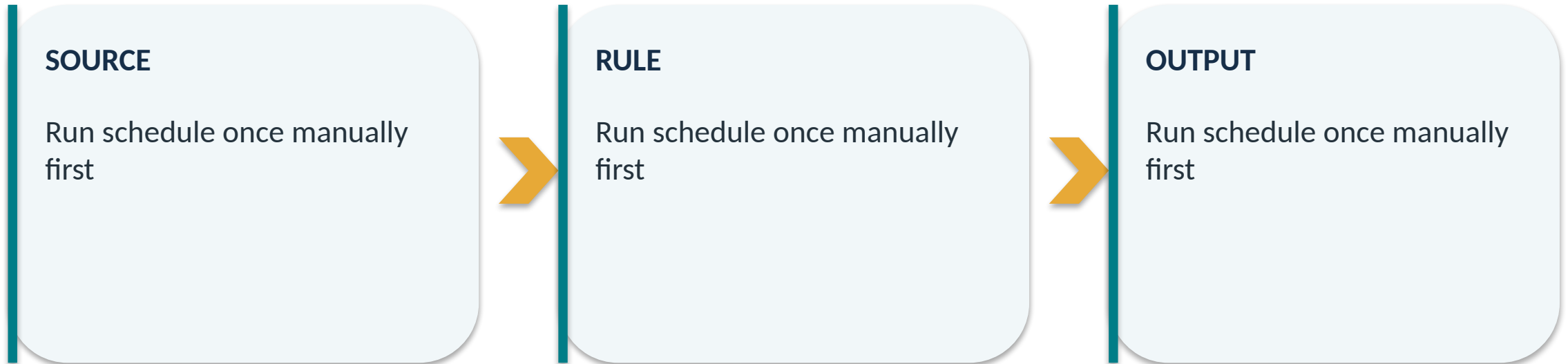
ACCEPT

Approved Reports separate from working folder

STOP / CORRECT

Cloud job cannot depend on a local-only path

On-demand rehearsal



Decision: Repeated run must not duplicate emails

On-demand rehearsal | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

One workbook, one release manifest

EXPECTED REVIEW

Repeated run must not duplicate emails

On-demand rehearsal | release gate

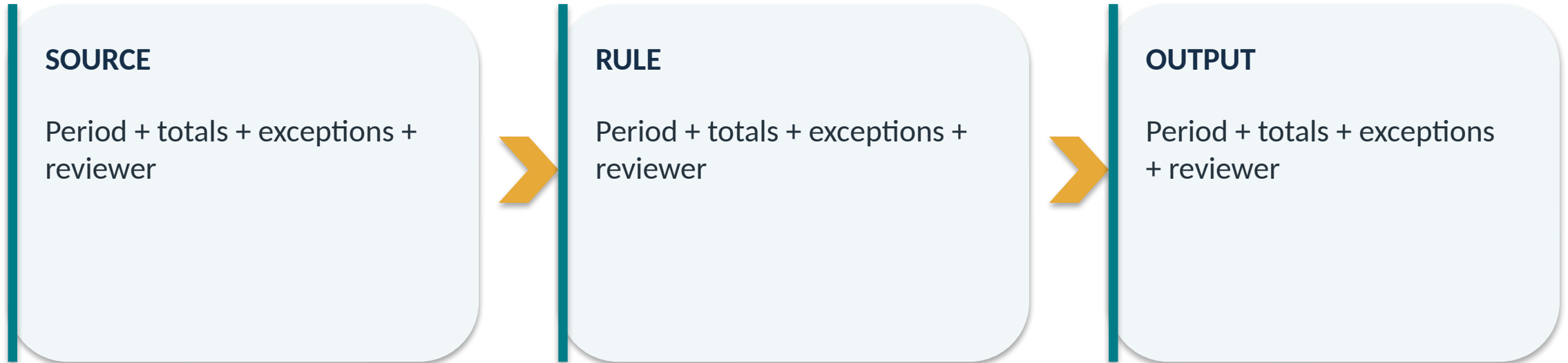
ACCEPT

One workbook, one release manifest

STOP / CORRECT

Repeated run must not duplicate emails

Review manifest



Decision: No approval record, no delivery

Review manifest | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

12 eligible and 2 excluded in September

EXPECTED REVIEW

No approval record, no delivery

Review manifest | release gate

ACCEPT

12 eligible and 2 excluded in September

STOP / CORRECT

No approval record, no delivery

Outlook connector



Decision: Attachment requirement needs another route

Outlook connector | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Native email includes link, not attachment

EXPECTED REVIEW

Attachment requirement needs another route

Outlook connector | release gate

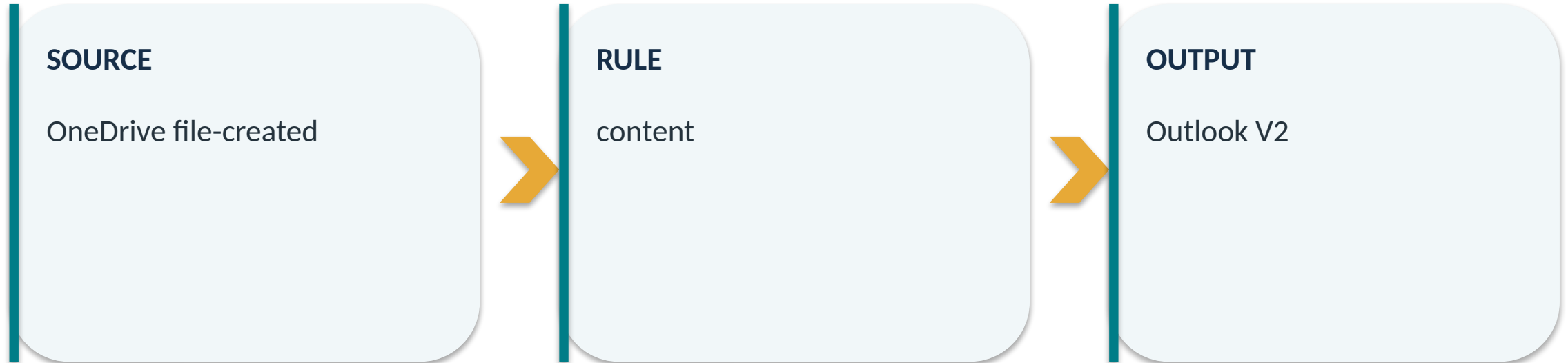
ACCEPT

Native email includes link, not attachment

STOP / CORRECT

Attachment requirement needs another route

Attachment flow



Decision: Never trigger on working files

Attachment flow | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Approved Reports/finance-report-sep-2026.xlsx

EXPECTED REVIEW

Never trigger on working files

Attachment flow | release gate

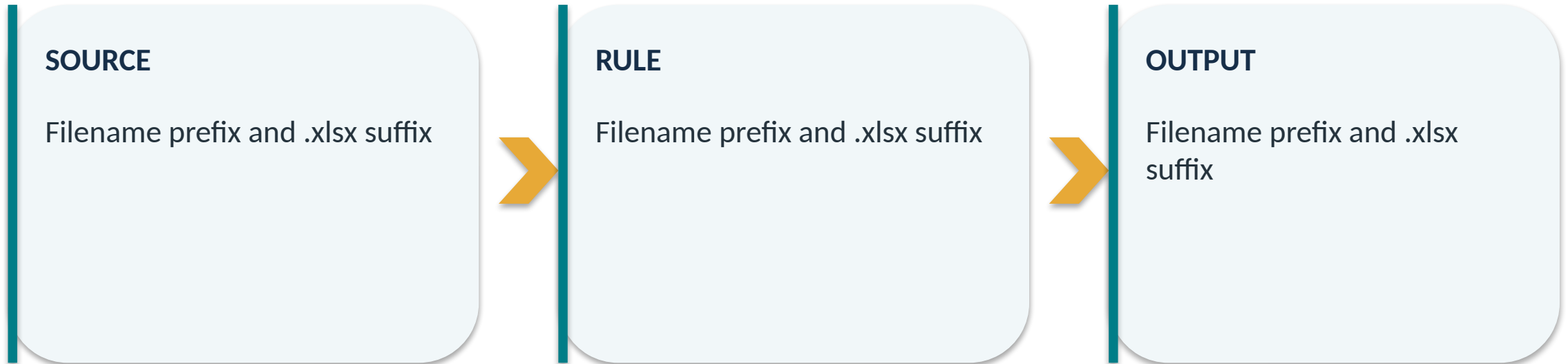
ACCEPT

Approved Reports/finance-report-
sep-2026.xlsx

STOP / CORRECT

Never trigger on working files

Flow condition



Decision: Other files must cause zero sends

Flow condition | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

finance-report-...xlsx only

EXPECTED REVIEW

Other files must cause zero sends

Flow condition | release gate

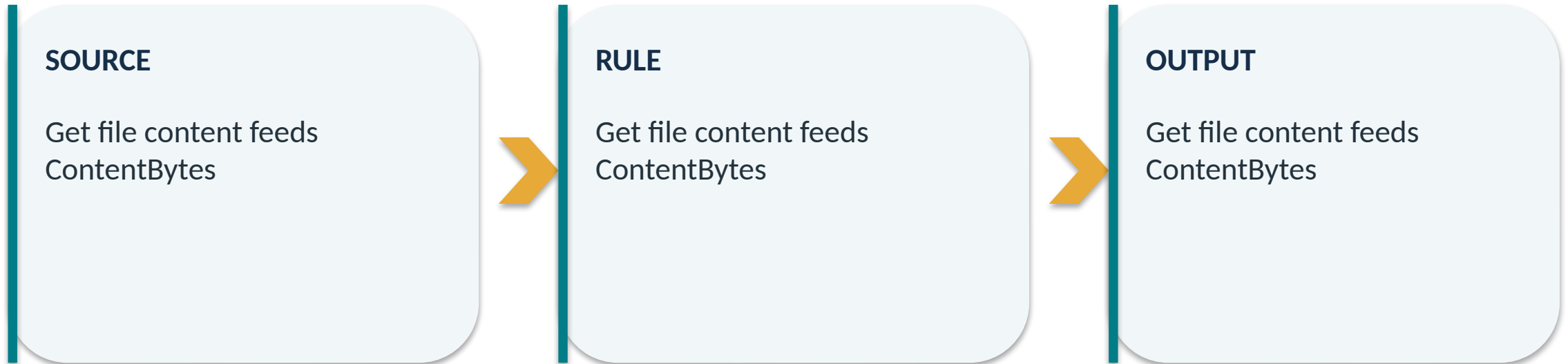
ACCEPT

finance-report-...xlsx only

STOP / CORRECT

Other files must cause zero sends

Attachment bytes



Decision: Check received attachment opens

Attachment bytes | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Name equals approved workbook filename

EXPECTED REVIEW

Check received attachment opens

Attachment bytes | release gate

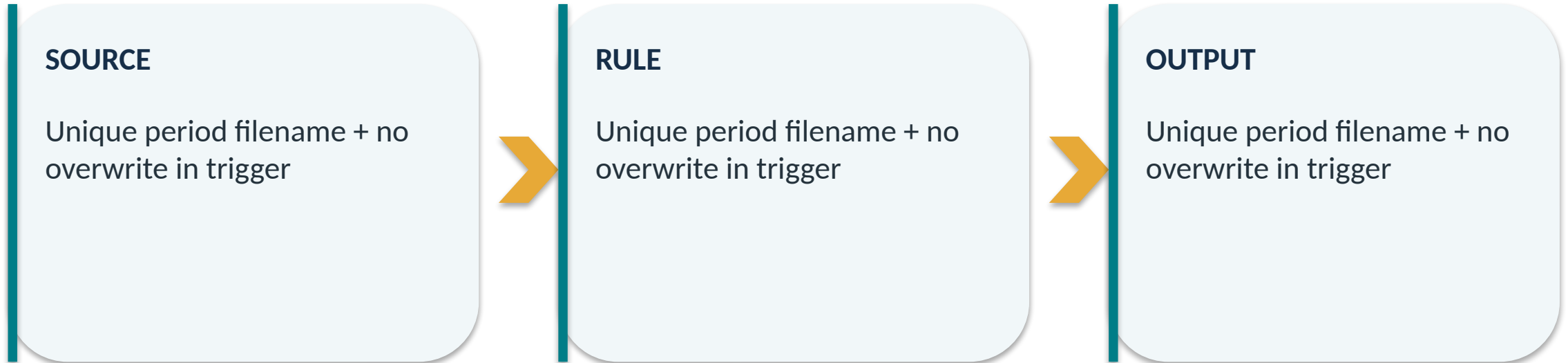
ACCEPT

Name equals approved workbook filename

STOP / CORRECT

Check received attachment opens

Idempotency



Decision: Duplicate send requires stop and investigation

Idempotency | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

One created file → one flow run → one Sent Item

EXPECTED REVIEW

Duplicate send requires stop and investigation

Idempotency | release gate

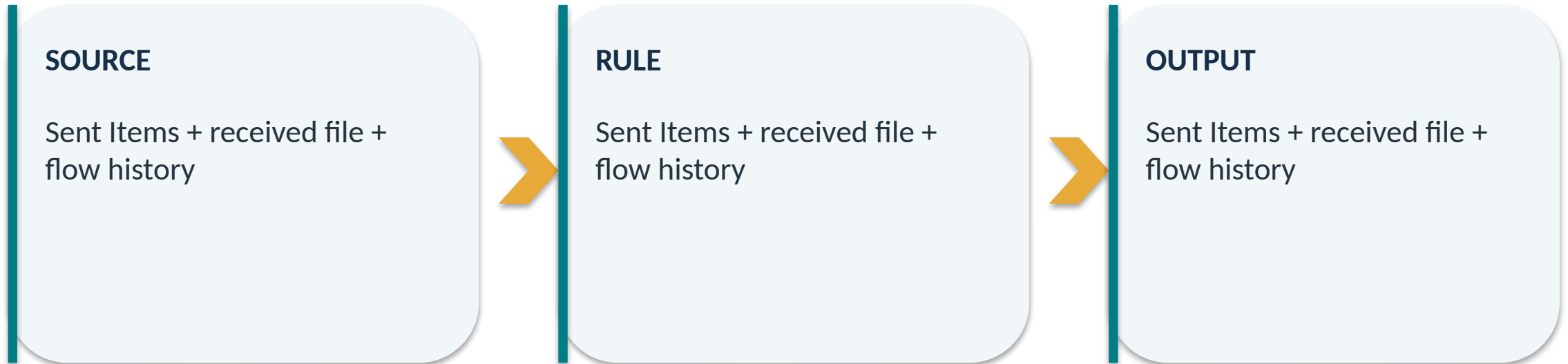
ACCEPT

One created file → one flow run → one Sent Item

STOP / CORRECT

Duplicate send requires stop and investigation

Delivery audit



Decision: A successful Cowork message alone is insufficient

Delivery audit | evidence

OBSERVED FINANCE RECORD

Subject, recipient, workbook version align

EXPECTED REVIEW

A successful Cowork message alone is insufficient

Delivery audit | release gate

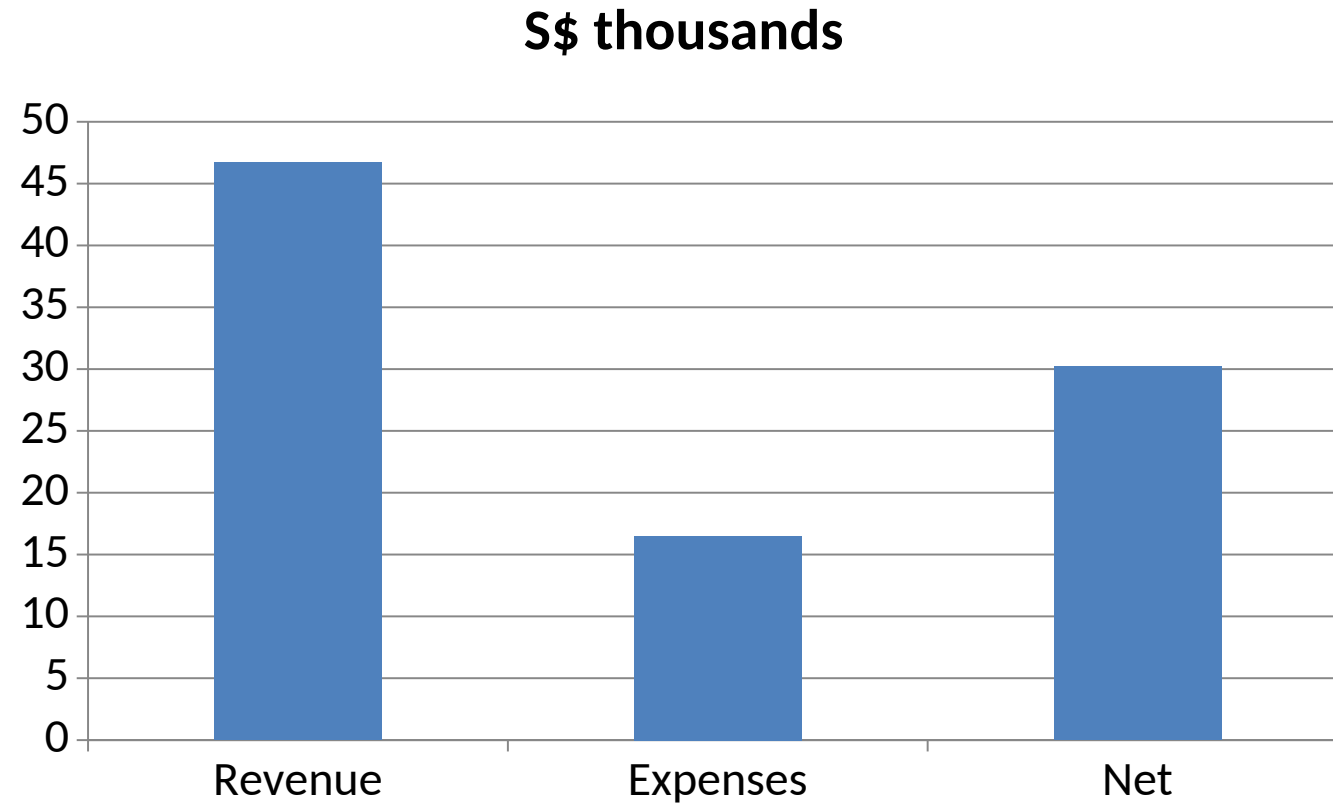
ACCEPT

Subject, recipient, workbook version align

STOP / CORRECT

A successful Cowork message alone is insufficient

August reconciliation dashboard



CONTROL TOTALS

Revenue 46,700

Expenses 16,500

Net 30,200

12 eligible • 2 excluded

Calculation cells must stay live

Revenue

=SUMIF(Eligible!E:E,">0",Eligible!E:E)

RECALCULATED VALUE

S\$46,700

Expenses

=-SUMIF(Eligible!E:E,"<0",Eligible!E:E)

RECALCULATED VALUE

S\$16,500

Net

=B2-B3

RECALCULATED VALUE

S\$30,200

One approved workbook, one email

BUILD

Cowork writes the period workbook

RECONCILE

Human checks totals and exceptions

APPROVE

Move final file to Approved Reports

DELIVER

Outlook flow attaches exact .xlsx

Run on-demand before enabling a cadence

LOCAL MODE

A local file or app requires the desktop available.

CLOUD MODE

Use connected OneDrive / SharePoint files and a reviewed flow.

Finance automation with evidence

Scope → calculate → reconcile → approve → deliver